

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1185

By Yager

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Larry Richard West of Huntsville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Larry Richard West of Huntsville; and

WHEREAS, Larry West was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on January 19, 1947, Mr. West was the son of Harold and Ida Bell Coffey West; and

WHEREAS, Larry West was a longtime teacher and businessman; following his college graduation, he taught in the Scott County School System and at the Tennessee Technology Center; and

WHEREAS, as the former manager of the Scott County Vocational Rehabilitation Board, Mr. West recognized the need for services and employment opportunities for citizens with developmental disabilities; in response to this need, in 1984, he established Scott Appalachian Industries (SAI) and served as executive director until his retirement; and

WHEREAS, SAI began small, with only two staff members and a \$42,000 budget, and provided habilitation services to only seven local citizens; now, this organization is one of Scott County's best-loved enterprises, largest employers, and cornerstone among local businesses, providing jobs, ongoing services, and human dignity to hundreds of individuals and families; and

WHEREAS, along with his successful career, Larry West was an active member of his community. In 1997, he founded Housing Opportunities and People Enterprises (HOPE), and he also developed an alternative fuel station using compressed natural gas within his community; he was very involved with youth athletics and helped start Scott County Junior Pro

leagues, coaching not only his children's youth teams but several Amateur Athletic Union (AAU) teams; and

WHEREAS, he was recently awarded Person of the Year by the *Independent Herald* and the Scott County Chamber of Commerce; and

WHEREAS, Larry West always remained committed to improving the lives of citizens in his community; to further this goal, he served on many State and special interest committees to improve both local and special interest policies; and

WHEREAS, Mr. West was deeply devoted to his faith and his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Larry West was an active member of White Rock Baptist Church, where he served in many roles and always strived to live in a manner that was pleasing to God; and

WHEREAS, Mr. West is survived by the love of his life and wife of fifty-eight years, Bonnie Keeton West; his children, Terina Cantrell, Kaprecia (Donnie) Babb, Toya (Ashley) Ellis, Bo Mandy (Chris) Yancey, and Miata (Michael) Richardson; his grandchildren, Taylon (Cole) West, Chevan (Heather) Brewster, Malaki (Haley) Ellis, Journey (Steadman) Rudd, Shaelee (Eli) Hembree, Sadie (Austin) West, Skye Babb, Stone Yancey, Hannah Ellis, Brody Yancey, Rygel Yancey, and Jep Yancey; his great-grandchildren, Hailyn West, Ellie West, Emrie West, Colden West, Gentry West, Hudson Ellis, Adley Rudd, Iva Hembree, McCoy Hembree, Auzie West, and Landry West; his sister-in-law, Mary Helen West; and a host of friends and church family; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Larry West was preceded in death by his beloved grandson, Kadon Tristin Babb; his great-granddaughter, Myla Rose Brewster; his father-in-law and mother-in-law, Seamon and Mable Buttram Keeton; his brothers, Arnold (Kathleen) West and Donald (Wanda) West; and his sister, Francine (Greg) Wilson; and

WHEREAS, Mr. West leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Larry Richard West, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. West.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.